

# > AI: Friend or Foe

accenture

Accenture STS | DevOps Brownbag

JAN 2026

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All images are created by Copilot AI  
except linked Tom Scott youtube thumbnail



# Purpose

AI Friend or Foe

Where is it going... ?

# Contents

- 1**      **Something has changed (2023)**
- 2**      **Something that changed (2008)**
- 3**      **The Sigmoid Curve**
- 4**      **Current Disruptions**
- 5**      **Signs of the peak ?**
- 6**      **Q & A**



## A prediction from 2023

Tom Scott, technology enthusiast, now retired science youtuber  
2 years since Co-Pilot launched



Source [YouTube Tom Scott: I tried using AI. It scared me. - YouTube](#)



# Purpose

Ouch... ok this has happened before

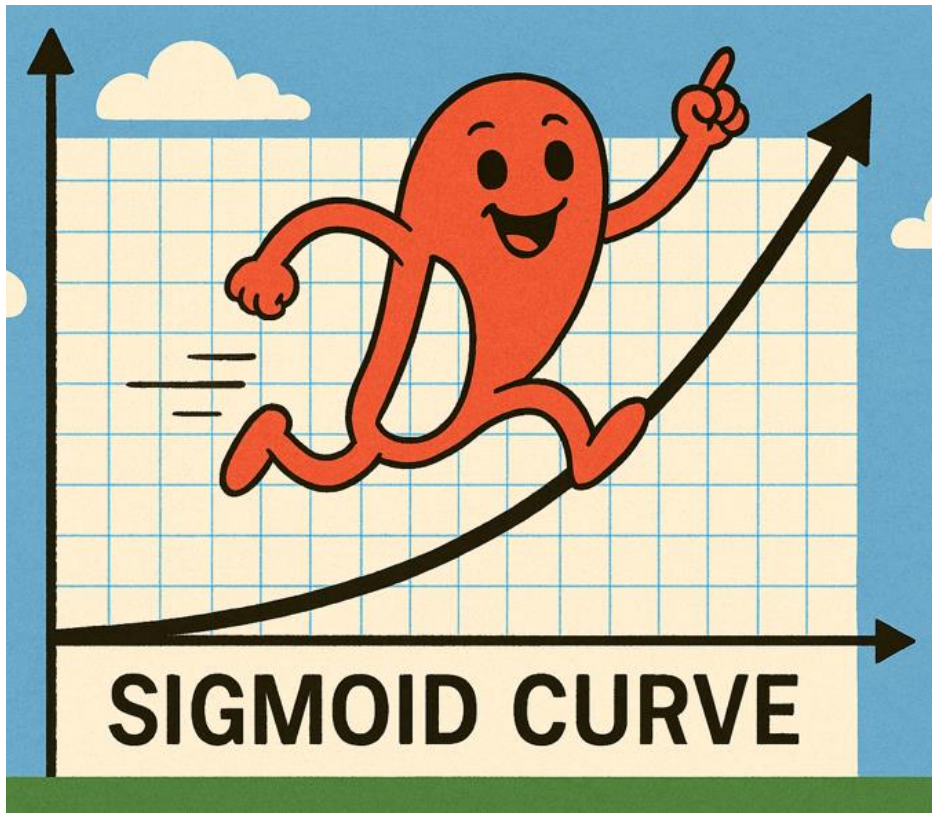
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## Message from 2008

From young excited games and media developer

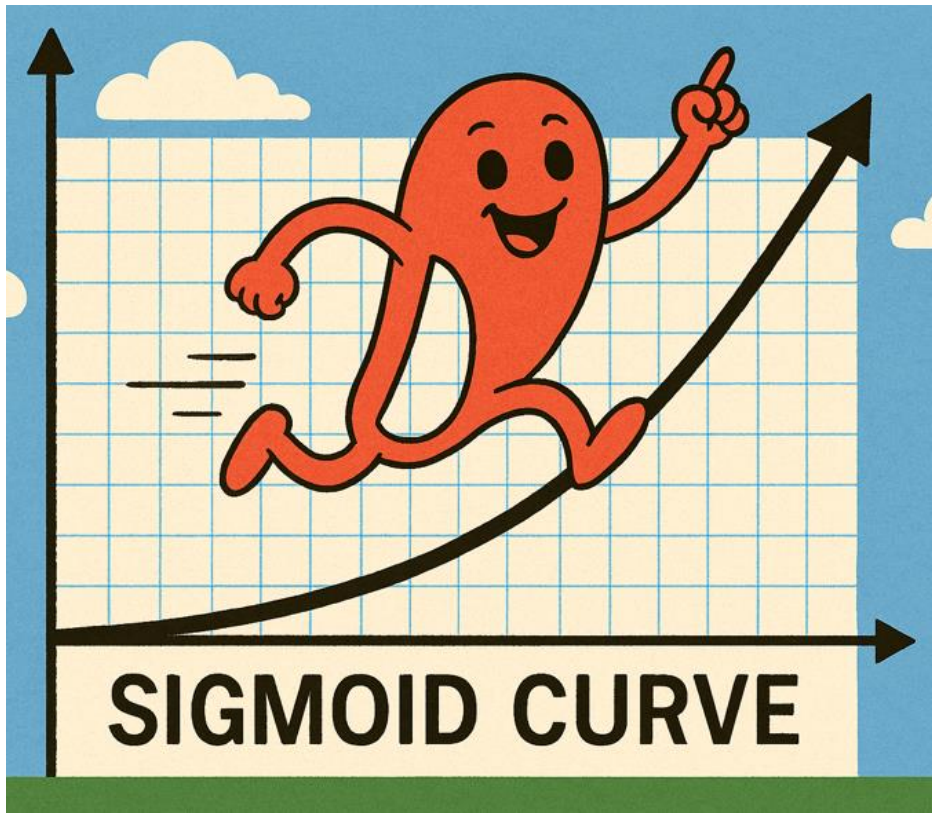


In 2008 Flash is alive and well !

- Millions of installs
- Best and only ubiquitous media player in town
- Fun and exciting to build in

## Message from 2008

*Flash is a happening and brilliant technology with a great future*



### Positives

- Silly **JavaScript** ditched ECMAScript 5, **fools...**
- **Chrome** making the web **better**

### Negatives

- **Adobe** bought macro media making it **corporate**
- **Apple** and mobile support **terrible**

## Report Message from 2026

From jaded head of DevOps

*Flash is a dead technology*



**JavaScript's** ECMAScript 6, was brilliant

**Chrome** fixed html video...

**Adobe** focused on flex, and neglected flash IDE killing it

**Apple** banned flash



# Purpose

Pattern of all things

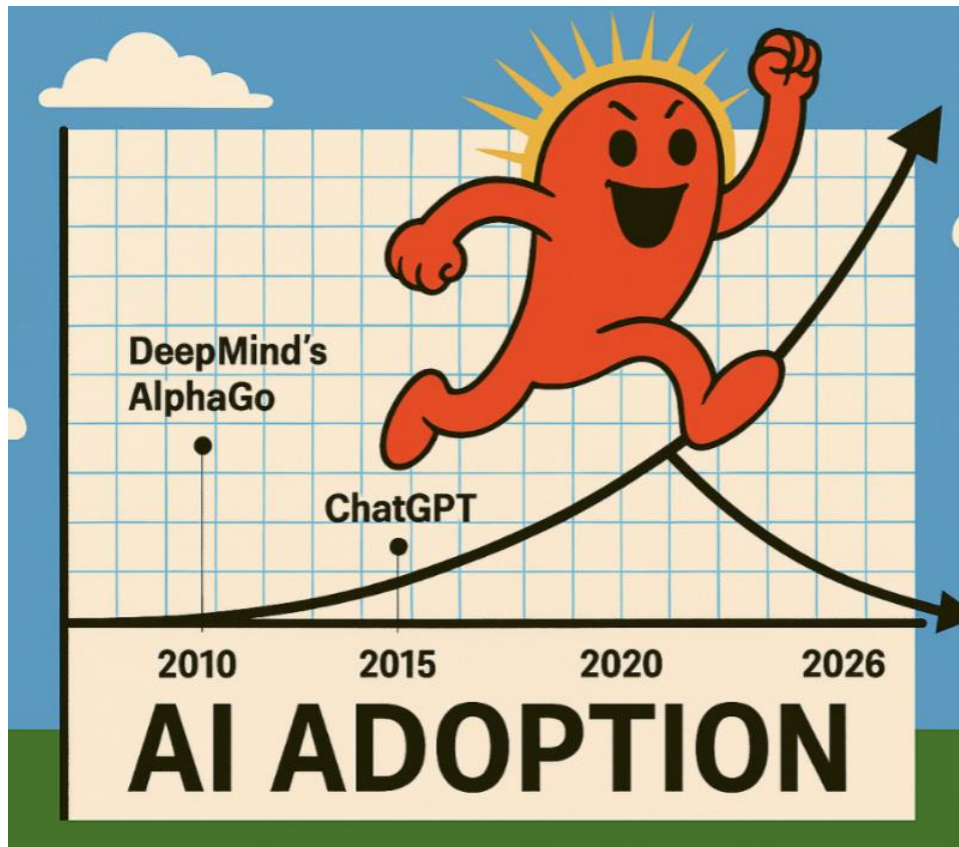
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Tech Sigmoid curves phases

*They disrupt then are disrupted*



## Slow stuttering start

GIFs

**NOTE: Disrupting Phase**

## Rapid Adoption and Growth

Web video, games, streaming !

**WARNING: Disruptee Phase**

## Decline and Obsolescence

Replaced by HTML (new hot thing)

**RELIEF: Disrupted Phase**

AI has had 40 years of slow false starts and dawns

*Always 10 years away until in 2010  
it wasn't\**

**NOTE: Disrupting Phase**

*\* ignoring object programming, OCR, decision trees,  
and neural networks, counting AI from genAI*

**START 2016-2021**

**2010s Photoshop Magic  
delete/patch**

**2016 Google Autodraw**

**2018 Deepfakes**

*Image Gen*

**2018 Chatbots GPT-1**

*Text Gen*

AI starting to disrupt

***WARNING: Disruptee Phase***

*Jobs at risk of change*

*loss and creation*

**MIDDLE 2021-XXXX**

**2021 Github Copilot launched**

*Code Gen – novice human*

**2022 ChatGPT**

*Text Gen – expert human*

**2022 MidJourney/Stable Diffusion**

*Video Gen – expert human*

**2024 Sora**

*Video Gen – expert human*

Are we there yet ?

*Can we see it ?*

**RELIEF: Disrupted Phase**

*Current Disruptions and Peak signs  
to follow...*

**END XXXX ?**



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Disruption recap

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## Disrupted Jobs

Voice Actors\* (Scottish train lady)

Graphic Designer

Videographers

Online/Offline Content Creators\*  
(News/Youtube slop)

Call Centre Workers

Translators

*Engineering\* (Entry level)*

## Created Jobs

MLOps

Infrastructure Engineer

Datacentre Engineers

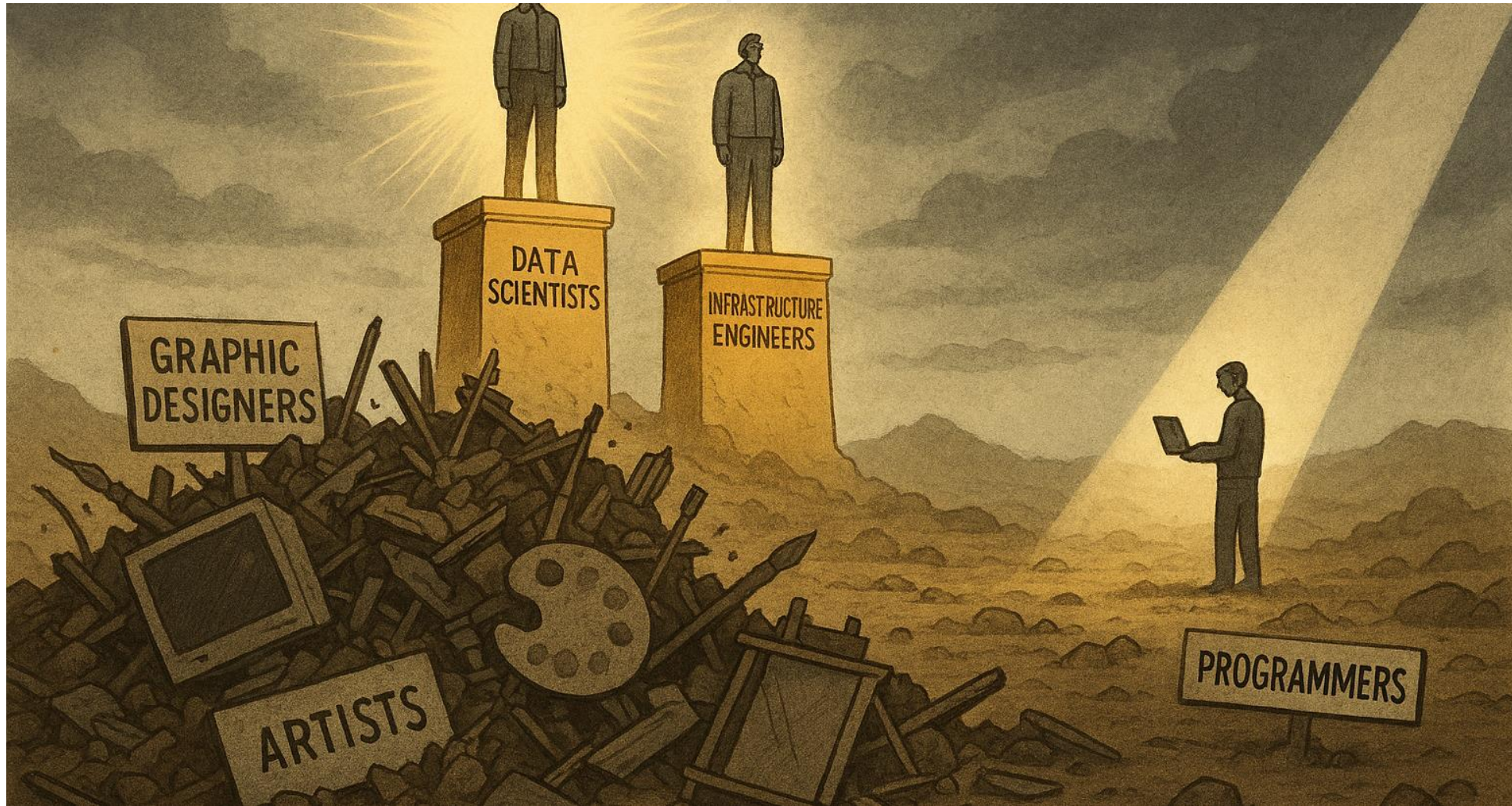
Prompt/Slop Engineers

## Empowered Jobs

*Engineering\**

## Graphic Designer replacement example

*From £100-200 1 day job, Into 10 seconds and £0.10 of compute*





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Hope ? Signs of the end ?

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## AI Warning Flags

Small collect of risks for AI's adoption

Any or none of these could flatten the curve

*Note: As with previous adoptions, disruptions will remain and harden*

- Accuracy and hallucination concerns\* (*Alaskan Lawcase* )
- Legal and Copyright concerns
- Stale Datasets and over fitting/training\* (*Dead internet theory*)
- Energy usage and environmental concerns\* (*trillions of litres*)
- Investment bubble\* (*AI is subsidised*)



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# Message from 2026

Don't panic, prepare

If you fail to **plan**; you **plan** to **fail**

## Tips:

- *Improve your soft skills*
- *Empower yourself with AI tools*
- *Look for opportunities created*

Food for thought:

AI is **XXX** programmers

- 1) *Empowering*
- 2) *Replacing*
- 3) *Creating jobs for*

AI is **XXX** for programmers

- 1) *Bad*
- 2) *Good*
- 3) *Ambivalent*